Culture Clash at Work 跨文化误会

1 直说还是委婉

说法	例句	中文对照
In China we usually hint.	**In China we usually hint** — we don't say no directly.	我们国内一般会暗示，不直接说不行。
They're often more direct.	**They're often more direct** — don't take it personally.	他们说话更直接，别往心里去。
"Not ideal" usually means no.	**"Not ideal" usually means no.**	说"不太理想"通常就是不行。
They expect you to say no.	**They expect you to say no** if you disagree.	你不同意就直接说，他们希望你这样。
It's not rude, it's just direct.	**It's not rude, it's just direct.**	这不是没礼貌，只是直接。
I'll be honest with you.	**I'll be honest with you** — I don't think this works.	我说实话，我觉得这样不行。

2 开会方式的差异

说法	例句	中文对照
People jump in without waiting.	**People jump in without waiting** — that's normal.	这儿的人不等别人说完就插话，很正常。
Silence can mean disagreement.	**Silence can mean disagreement** in some meetings.	有些会上，没人说话其实就是不同意。
First names, even with the boss.	**First names, even with the boss** — that's normal.	直呼老板名字，在他们那儿很正常。
They expect you to give an opinion.	**They expect you to give an opinion** — say something.	他们期待你发表意见，说点什么。
Small talk comes before business.	**Small talk comes before business** — five minutes.	他们先寒暄再谈正事，大概五分钟。
Deadlines are firm there.	**Deadlines are firm there** — a day late is late.	他们那边截止期很硬，晚一天就是晚。

3 微信、邮件和加班的误会

说法	例句	中文对照
We use WeChat for work here.	**We use WeChat for work here** — email is slower.	我们工作用微信，邮件太慢。
He was surprised we reply late.	**He was surprised we reply late.**	他没想到我们回消息这么晚。
Overtime is normal in our office.	**Overtime is normal in our office** — 8 p.m. is early.	我们公司加班很正常。
She thought nobody had weekends.	**She thought nobody had weekends.**	她以为我们整周都不休息。
I'll explain it if they ask.	**I'll explain it if they ask** — no need to defend.	他们问我就解释，不用辩解。
It's not rude, it's how we work.	**It's not rude, it's how we work.**	这不是不礼貌，就是我们的习惯。

4 饭桌、礼物和小事

说法	例句	中文对照
Don't bring up salary or politics.	**Don't bring up salary or politics** at dinner.	饭桌上别聊工资和政治。
Keep gifts small and useful.	**Keep gifts small and useful** — tea is fine.	礼物小而实用就行，茶叶就不错。
They open gifts right away.	**They open gifts right away** — it's not rude there.	他们会当场拆礼物，在他们那儿不失礼。
Numbers have meanings here.	**Numbers have meanings here** — avoid 4 if you can.	数字有讲究，能避开 4 就避开。
Ask before you take photos.	**Ask before you take photos** in a factory.	在工厂拍照前先问一声。

5 遇到不舒服时怎么说

说法	例句	中文对照
That's not how we usually do it.	**That's not how we usually do it** here.	我们这边一般不这么做。
Can I explain how it works here?	**Can I explain how it works here?**	我解释一下我们这边的做法行吗？
I think there's a misunderstanding.	**I think there's a misunderstanding** about the date.	日期上我想有个误会。
I don't want to be rude.	**I don't want to be rude** — just checking.	我不是要冒犯，就是确认一下。
Let's talk about it offline.	**Let's talk about it offline** — not in the meeting.	这个私下聊，别在会上说。
I'll take that as feedback.	**I'll take that as feedback** — thanks.	我当建议收下了，谢谢。

6 常见错误

常见错误	正确说法	说明
You are too direct, it is impolite.	That’s more direct than we’re used to.	别直接说对方没礼貌。
Foreigners don’t understand China.	It works differently here — let me explain.	别说” 外国人不懂中国”。
Sorry, our culture is different.	In China we usually do it this way.	用陈述代替道歉。
I can’t drink, it’s our culture.	I don’t drink, but I’ll join with tea.	culture 不是挡酒的理由。
You should learn Chinese culture.	Let me tell you how we do it here.	别要求对方去学。
Chinese people always work overtime.	Many teams work late in peak season.	避免以偏概全。

7 Discussion 讨论

Question	中文对照
Have you worked with people from other countries?	你跟外国人共事过吗?
What surprised you most about foreign colleagues?	外国同事最让你意外的是什么?
Is direct feedback rude in your view?	你觉得直接给反馈是没礼貌吗?
What’s hard to explain about Chinese work culture?	中国职场的哪些习惯不好跟老外解释?
What do foreigners usually get wrong about us?	老外通常误会我们什么?